Q. Which Congress leader is best suited to revive the party?



RAHUL GANDHI
23
19
17
15



MANMOHAN SINGH
16
13
14
16



SACHIN PILOT
14
12
11
12



PRIYANKA GANDHI
9
12
12
10



SONIA GANDHI
6
10
10
10

Aug. 2022 Jan. 2022
Aug. 2021 Jan. 2021

Note: Rest DK/ CS (Don't know/ Can't say) and Others

All figures in percentage

Q. Who among the non-Gandhi leaders is best suited to lead the Congress?



MANMOHAN SINGH
29
30
28
27



SACHIN PILOT
20
12
17
17



P. CHIDAMBARAM
8
5
7
8



ASHOK GEHLOT
6
4
6
6



GHULAM NABI AZAD
5
4
5
4

Aug. 2022 Jan. 2022
Aug. 2021 Jan. 2021

Note: Rest DK/ CS (Don't know/ Can't say) and Others



BLACK DAY
Sonia Gandhi, Rahul and other Congress leaders at the Aug. 5 opposition protests in Delhi

that has often haunted the Congress in the past eight years. This is not the first time that the party, including top leaders such as Sonia, Rahul and Priyanka Gandhi have hit the streets to raise national issues. From forcing the Modi government in 2015 to retract the proposed amendments to the Land Acquisition Rehabilitation and Resettlement Act (2013) to walking alongside the migrants during the Covid-induced lockdown in 2020, to targeting the government regularly on economic issues, the Congress, particularly Rahul, has donned the role of a fiery opposition in the past. And the MOTN poll suggests that people have been appreciative of the party's performance as an opposition party—from 33 per cent rating the performance as good or outstanding six months ago to nearly 40 per cent saying so in the current round.

But it has still not been able to take people along as most its actions on the ground have been flashes in the pan. The party hasn't been able to sustain a long, vigorous campaign nor has it had a cohesive narrative. And most respondents seem to find the top leadership—the Gandhi family—responsible for this lack of momentum. The party continues to project the family as the last hope, but more than half of the respondents say the Congress is better off without the Gandhis. Yet for those who still believe in the currency of the party's first family, Rahul remains the first choice to revive it. The dearth of leadership is evident as nearly 18 per cent respondents back octogenarian Manmohan Singh, who is almost out of political action, as a possible saviour of the party.

This is in sharp contrast to an ageing Sonia Gandhi, who not just holds the reins of the party, but has also recently displayed renewed energy inside and outside Parliament. But only six